

Absolutely — **custom** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “they also make **custom birthday cakes**...”

Here **custom** means **made specially for a particular customer according to their requirements**, not “usual practice” or “tradition”. But **custom** also has major meanings involving **tradition, habitual practice, customers/business, and made-to-order products**.

# Word family: **custom / customs / customer / customize / customized / customization**

**Base word:** custom

**Plural:** customs

**Related noun:** customer

**Verb:** customize

**Adjective/participle:** customized

**Noun:** customization

**Part of speech:** noun ( 名詞 ) / adjective ( 形容詞 )

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# Meaning in your passage: **custom = made specially for a particular customer — 訂製的；度身訂造的**

Your phrase:

> “custom birthday cakes”

Here **custom** means:

> **made specially according to one customer’s requested design, size, flavour, wording, or other preferences.**

**繁體中文：**

**按照個別顧客的要求特別製作，而不是使用標準固定款式；訂製的 / 度身訂造的**

Natural translation:

> “custom birthday cakes”

「**訂製生日蛋糕**」

So here:

> **custom = 按顧客要求特別製作的**

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# 1. **custom** = made to order / specially designed — 訂製的；特製的

This is your exact source sense.

#### ### Practice 1 — Original

> “They make **custom birthday cakes**.”

「他們製作**訂製生日蛋糕**。」

#### ### Practice 2

> “She ordered a **custom wedding cake**.”

「她訂了一個**特製 / 訂製婚禮蛋糕**。」

#### ### Practice 3

> “The shop offers custom designs for special occasions.”

「這間店為特別場合提供**訂製設計**。」

**custom** — adjective = 按特定顧客的要求、尺寸、風格或用途特別製作

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# 2. **custom** = tradition / established social practice — 習俗；風俗

A major distinct noun meaning.

#### ### Practice 4

> “It is a local **custom** to exchange gifts during the festival.”

「節日期間交換禮物是一項本地**習俗**。」

#### ### Practice 5

> “The ceremony follows an old **custom**.”

「這個儀式遵循一項古老的**風俗**。」

**custom** = 一個社會、地區或群體長期形成並普遍遵守的傳統做法

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# 3. \*\*custom = habitual practice of a person/group — 慣例；習慣做法\*\*

A closely related but more individual/institutional sense.

#### ### Practice 6

> “It was his \*\*custom\*\* to arrive early.”

「他一向有提早到達的\*\*習慣\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 7

> “By custom, the meeting begins with introductions.”

「按照\*\*慣例\*\*，會議會先作自我介紹。」

\*\*custom = 長期重複而形成的慣常做法\*\*

This is less about cultural tradition and more about repeated habit/convention.

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# 4. \*\*custom = regular business from customers — 顧客生意；惠顧\*\*

A major older/commercial sense that survives in specific contexts.

#### ### Practice 8

> “The shop depends on local \*\*custom\*\*.”

「這間店依賴本地顧客的\*\*惠顧\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 9

> “Thank you for your custom.”

「感謝你的\*\*惠顧\*\*。」

\*\*custom = 顧客對商店或企業的購買 / 光顧\*\*

Register:

\* especially BrE

\* somewhat formal/traditional

This is directly related historically to **customer**.

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# 5. **customs** = customs authority / border control — 海關

A completely distinct plural meaning.

### Practice 10

> “We had to go through **customs** at the airport.”

「我們在機場要經過**海關**。」

### Practice 11

> “The goods were stopped by customs.”

「貨物被**海關**扣查。」

**customs** = 負責檢查出入境貨物、行李及徵收相關稅款的政府部門 / 程序

This is always plural in this sense.

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# 6. **customs** = import/export duties — 關稅；海關稅

A related financial/legal use.

### Practice 12

> “The company had to pay **customs duties**.”

「公司必須支付**關稅**。」

### Practice 13

> “Customs charges can increase the final price.”

「**海關費用 / 關稅**可能令最終價格上升。」

**customs** = 與進出口貨物相關的海關徵稅制度 / 費用

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# 7. \*\*custom-made = 度身訂造的；訂製的\*\*

A very common compound.

### Practice 14

> “The shelves were \*\*custom-made\*\* for the room.”

「那些層架是為房間\*\*度身訂造\*\*的。」

### Practice 15

> “She wore a custom-made dress.”

「她穿了一條\*\*訂製連身裙\*\*。」

\*\*custom-made = 按特定個人或用途專門製作\*\*

Very close to adjective \*\*custom\*\*.

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# 8. \*\*custom-built = 特製的；按需要建造的\*\*

A common product/technical compound.

### Practice 16

> “They use a \*\*custom-built\*\* oven.”

「他們使用一個\*\*特製烤爐\*\*。」

### Practice 17

> “The studio has a custom-built storage system.”

「工作室有一套\*\*按需要特製的收納系統\*\*。」

\*\*custom-built = 專門為某個使用者、用途或環境建造\*\*

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# 9. \*\*customize = customize something — 自訂；訂製；個人化\*\*

A major modern family verb.

### ### Practice 18

> “Customers can **customize** the cake design.”

「顧客可以**自訂 / 訂製**蛋糕設計。」

### ### Practice 19

> “You can customize the colours and text.”

「你可以**自訂**顏色和文字。」

**customize** = 按個人需要修改產品、設計、設定或功能

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# 10. **customized** = customized for someone — 訂製的；自訂的；個人化的

### ### Practice 20

> “The bakery offers **customized** cakes.”

「這間麵包店提供**訂製蛋糕**。」

### ### Practice 21

> “The software provides customized recommendations.”

「這套軟件提供**個人化建議**。」

**customized** = 已根據特定使用者需要作修改 / 配置的

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# 11. **customization** = 自訂；個人化；訂製

### ### Practice 22

> “The website allows extensive **customization**.”

「這個網站容許高度**自訂 / 個人化設定**。」

### ### Practice 23

> “Customization increases the price of the product.”

「\*\*訂製\*\*會提高產品價格。」

\*\*customization = 按使用者需求修改產品、服務或設定的過程\*\*

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# 12. \*\*customer = 顧客；客戶\*\*

A major family extension.

### Practice 24

> “The staff know many \*\*customers\*\* by name.”

「店員認得很多\*\*顧客\*\*的名字。」

### Practice 25

> “Good service helps keep customers loyal.”

「良好服務有助維持\*\*顧客忠誠度\*\*。」

\*\*customer = 向商店 / 企業購買商品或服務的人\*\*

This is directly relevant to your passage.

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# 13. \*\*customer base = 顧客群；客戶基礎\*\*

A common business compound.

### Practice 26

> “The bakery has built a loyal \*\*customer base\*\*.”

「這間麵包店建立了忠實的\*\*顧客群\*\*。」

### Practice 27

> “The company is trying to expand its customer base.”

「公司正嘗試擴大\*\*客戶群\*\*。」

\*\*customer base = 一間企業現有或穩定的顧客群體\*\*

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# Important distinction: **custom vs customer**

### **custom**

can mean:

- \* 習俗
- \* 訂製的
- \* 惠顧

### **customer**

= 顧客

So:

> custom cake

> = 訂製蛋糕

> customer

> = 購買蛋糕的人

Very important family contrast.

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# Important distinction: **custom vs tradition**

### **custom**

= repeated social practice

### **tradition**

= broader inherited belief/practice passed down over time

A tradition may include many customs.

> custom = 具體習俗

> tradition = 傳統體系 / 傳統做法

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# Important distinction: **custom vs habit**

### ### \*\*habit\*\*

usually individual repeated behaviour.

### ### \*\*custom\*\*

often social/group practice, though it can also mean personal habitual practice in formal English.

> personal habit

> = 個人習慣

> local custom

> = 地方習俗

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# Important distinction: \*\*custom vs convention\*\*

### ### \*\*custom\*\*

= repeated practice that has become normal.

### ### \*\*convention\*\*

= accepted rule/practice, often more formal or institutional.

> social custom

> = 社會習俗

> writing convention

> = 寫作慣例

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# Important distinction: \*\*custom vs bespoke\*\*

### ### \*\*custom\*\*

= made specially for a customer.

### ### \*\*bespoke\*\*

= made specifically to order, especially in BrE, often high-end.

> custom cake

> = 訂製蛋糕

> bespoke suit

> = 度身訂造西裝

**Bespoke** often sounds more premium/formal.

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# Important distinction: **custom vs personalized**

### **custom**

= product itself may be specially designed/modified.

### **personalized**

= adapted to one person, often by adding name/preferences.

> custom cake design

> = 整體訂製設計

> personalized cake topper

> = 加上個人名字的蛋糕裝飾

Overlap exists, but **custom** can imply deeper modification.

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# Important distinction: **custom vs customized**

### **custom**

often adjective before noun:

> custom cake

### **customized**

emphasizes that something has been modified:

> customized cake design

Both can mean:

> 訂製的

But **custom** is often cleaner and more product-like.

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# Important distinction: **custom vs standard**

### **custom**

= specially made for particular requirements.

### **standard**

= regular default version made for general use.

> custom size

> = 訂製尺寸

> standard size

> = 標準尺寸

Direct contrast.

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# Important distinction: **customs vs custom**

### Singular:

> custom

> = 習俗 / 訂製

### Plural lexicalized:

> customs

> = 海關

This is one of the strongest MCQ traps.

> local customs

> can mean:

> = 當地習俗

but:

> go through customs

> = 過海關

Context is crucial.

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# Important distinction: **customs** = traditions vs customs = border authority

### “local customs”

= 當地習俗

### “airport customs”

= 機場海關

Same plural form, completely different meanings.

Excellent MCQ contrast.

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# Important distinction: **custom** = customer business

This commercial sense is less common in everyday international English, but still useful:

> “Thank you for your custom.”

= 感謝惠顧

Compare:

> “Thank you for being our customer.”

= 感謝你成為我們的顧客

The first sounds more formal/BrE/traditional.

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# Important note on polysemy depth

**Custom** has a compact but genuinely strong modern inventory:

1. **custom** = tradition / established practice
2. **custom** = made specially for a customer

3. **custom** = business/patronage
4. **customs** = border authority / import system

Then the most useful family extensions are:

- \* customer
- \* customize
- \* customized
- \* customization
- \* custom-made
- \* custom-built

These are worth keeping because they develop into distinct high-frequency modern meanings.

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#### # Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- \* **custom — made to order** = 訂製的 / 度身訂造的
- \* **custom — tradition** = 習俗 / 風俗
- \* **custom — habitual practice** = 慣例 / 習慣做法
- \* **custom — patronage** = 惠顧 / 顧客生意
- \* **customs — border authority** = 海關
- \* **customs — duties** = 關稅 / 海關費用
- \* **custom-made** = 度身訂造的
- \* **custom-built** = 特製 / 按需要建造的
- \* **customize** = 自訂 / 個人化
- \* **customized** = 訂製 / 自訂 / 個人化的
- \* **customization** = 自訂 / 個人化 / 訂製
- \* **customer** = 顧客 / 客戶
- \* **customer base** = 顧客群 / 客戶基礎

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#### # Master comparison

| Form / sense                      | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                             | -----                                 |
| <b>custom — made to order</b>     | 按個別顧客的要求、尺寸、風格或用途特別製作的                |
| <b>custom — tradition</b>         | 一個社會、地區或群體長期形成並普遍遵守的做法                |
| <b>custom — habitual practice</b> | 長期重複而形成的慣常做法 / 慣例                     |
| <b>custom — patronage</b>         | 顧客對某商店 / 企業的購買與惠顧                     |
| <b>customs — border authority</b> | 負責檢查出入境貨物、行李及徵收相關稅款的政府部門 / 程序         |

|                             |                         |  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------|--|
| <b>**customs — duties**</b> | 進出口貨物所涉及的關稅 / 海關費用      |  |
| <b>**custom-made**</b>      | 按特定個人 / 用途專門製作的         |  |
| <b>**custom-built**</b>     | 為特定用途或環境專門建造的           |  |
| <b>**customize**</b>        | 按個人需要修改產品、設計、設定或功能      |  |
| <b>**customized**</b>       | 已根據特定使用者需求修改 / 配置的      |  |
| <b>**customization**</b>    | 按使用者需求修改產品 / 服務 / 設定的過程 |  |
| <b>**customer**</b>         | 向企業購買商品或服務的人            |  |
| <b>**customer base**</b>    | 一間企業現有或穩定的顧客群體          |  |

# For your original sentence

> “On top of that, they also make **\*\*custom birthday cakes\*\***...”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*custom = Golden Crust 會按照顧客指定的款式、口味、尺寸、文字或主題來特別製作生日蛋糕，而不是只賣固定標準款。\*\***

Natural translation:

> **\*\*「除此之外，他們也會製作訂製生日蛋糕。」\*\***

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **\*\*custom cake\*\*** → 訂製蛋糕
- > **\*\*local custom\*\*** → 當地習俗
- > **\*\*personal custom\*\*** → 慣常做法
- > **\*\*thank you for your custom\*\*** → 感謝惠顧
- > **\*\*customs at the airport\*\*** → 機場海關
- > **\*\*customs duty\*\*** → 關稅
- > **\*\*customize\*\*** → 自訂 / 個人化
- > **\*\*customer\*\*** → 顧客
- > **\*\*custom vs standard\*\*** → 訂製 vs 標準款